



World Flora Online



**A Global Gateway to Plant
Knowledge**

Documenting Earth's Plant Diversity

Plants are the foundation of life on earth. They form the basis of most terrestrial ecosystems and hold the keys to addressing many of the world's health, social, environmental, and economic challenges. Among the estimated 450,000 known plant species, 40% are threatened with extinction and over 70,000 await scientific description. Preserving this incredible diversity begins with a vital first step: documenting it.

World Flora Online (WFO) is a unique international initiative that provides open-access, authoritative and continually updated information on all known plant species. WFO already includes nearly 380,000 plant species, with the goal of providing up-to-date taxonomic treatments for 80% of all known plants by 2030.

One Global Resource for all Known Plants

WFO brings together two fundamental components into a single global portal: a consensus classification of the world's plants along with detailed species profiles, including descriptions, synonyms, uses, conservation status, threats, images and maps.

WFO also highlights where new information is needed, for example on poorly known groups and unexplored regions, stimulating research and collaborations to fill those knowledge gaps.

An Essential Tool for Conservation and Biodiversity Preservation

A full and authoritative inventory of plant life is essential in the face of accelerating global change.

WFO equips scientists, decision-makers, and conservation practitioners with the knowledge to protect the world's botanical wealth. WFO supports conservation planning, policy-making, botanical research and sustainable use of plant resources.

Rooted in International Agreements

WFO was established in response to the Convention on Biodiversity's Global Strategy for Plant Conservation (GSPC) – first adopted in 2002 and updated in 2010 and 2024. WFO meets one of GSPC's main goals: to identify and map all plant species on earth. It is also the only international initiative explicitly mentioned in the Voluntary Complementary Actions supporting the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework.

A Unique Scientific Collaboration

WFO is created, curated, moderated, and updated by a global community of botanical experts. Led by a consortium of over 50 botanical institutions worldwide, this collaborative effort ensures that taxonomic knowledge is widely shared and contributes directly to one of humanity's greatest challenges: preserving biodiversity.



WFO
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